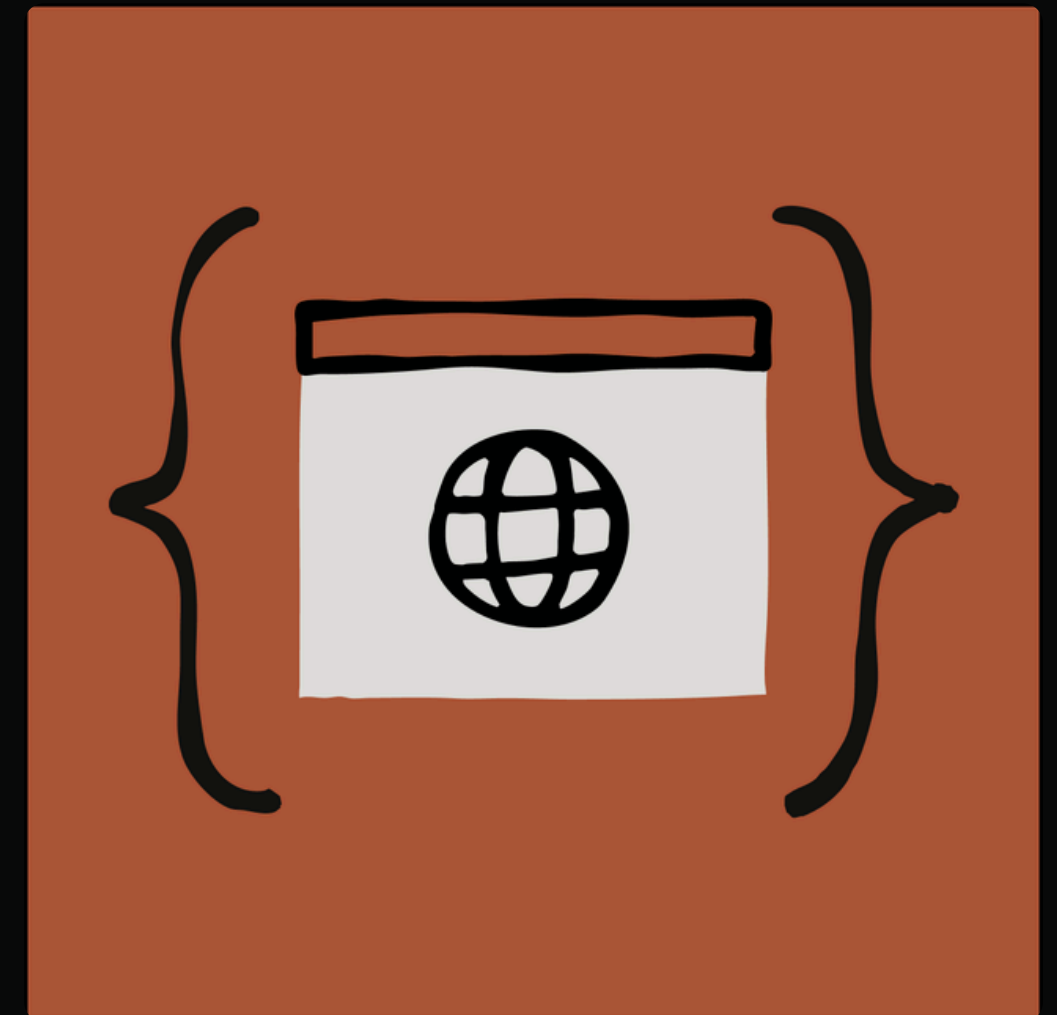


EPISTEME

“A Socratic AI that refuses to answer your questions
and instead helps you answer them yourself”.

By

Atharv Khare

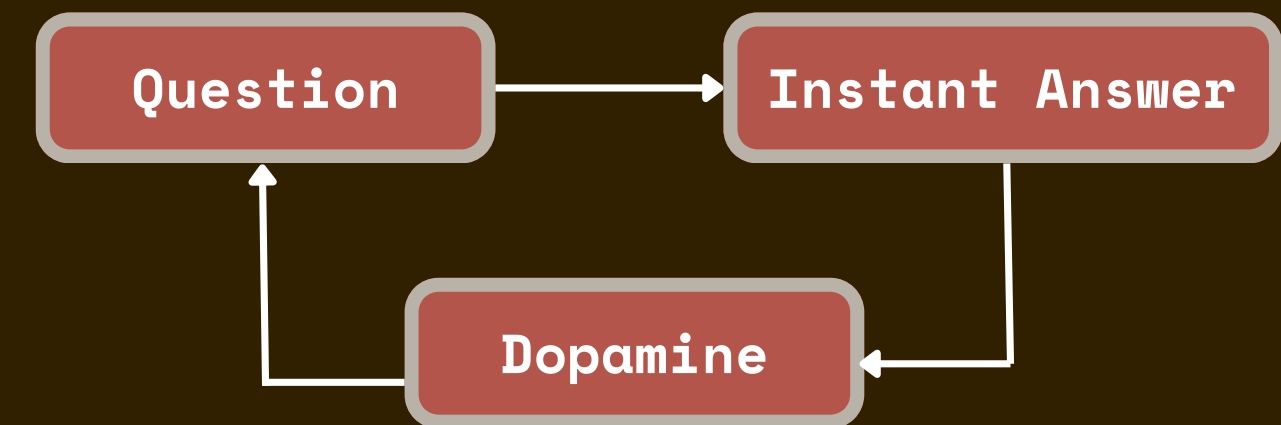


*Every AI in 2026 is optimising for
user satisfaction.*

*We are optimising for
user growth.*

These are not the same thing. The gap between them is the entire product.

// THE LOOP THAT DESTROYS LEARNING



// USER STATE :

✓ Can define gradient descent

✗ Cannot explain the effect of lr

✓ Knows what overfitting means

✗ Cannot fix it on a novel dataset

✓ Passed every online test

✗ Failed the placement interview

Not prompt engineering. A deterministic cognitive pipeline.

RDSE

Response Depth Signal Extractor

// ARXIV 2512.03501

BGDC

Bloom-Grounded Depth Classifier

// ARXIV 2511.10903 • NOV 2025

SDSM

Socratic Dialogue State Machine

// SOCRATICLLM • CIKM 2024

CBKT-CS

Conversational BKT Clarity Scorer

// CORBETT & ANDERSON 1994 • PIECH ET AL.

SUV

Semantic Understanding Verifier

// JEDM 2025

CPGAB

Concept Prerequisite Graph Builder

// ACL 2024 + JEDM 2025

EGP — EBBINGHAUS GAP PRIORITIZER

// EBBINGHAUS 1885 • WOZNIAK SM-2 1987

Why Episteme is not another AI tutor.

COMPETITOR	WHAT THEY OPTIMISE FOR	WHAT EPISTEME DOES INSTEAD
Claude.ai / ChatGPT	Answering questions completely	Refuses to answer, probes first
Khan Academy AI	Explaining concepts clearly	Socratic dialogue, not explanation
Duolingo	Gamified repetition and recall	Depth-first understanding
Coursera AI	Supplementing course content	Works on any question, any domain
Perplexity	Research speed	Anti-answer by philosophical design
Human tutors	Expensive, inaccessible	Democratised, asynchronous, scalable

"Can't you just prompt Claude to be Socratic?"

DIMENSION	PROMPT-ENGINEERED	FINE-TUNED MODEL	EPISTEME
Turn strategy	Hopes LLM stays Socratic	Fixed trained behaviour	7-state SDSM · deterministic
Depth scoring	LLM judgement, variable	Model output, fixed	3-signal BGDC fusion
Mastery tracking	None	None	BKT per turn, persisted to DB
Misconception	Hopes LLM notices	May catch common cases	SUV every turn, RECTIFY fires
Breaks under pressure	Yes – user can force answer	No – but inflexible	No – SDSM cannot be argued with
Cross-session memory	Session only	None	Metacognitive agent + fingerprint
Export	None	None	MD · PDF · Notion API

Scales to millions. Costs almost nothing.

USERS	CLAUDE API	SUPABASE	VERCEL	TOTAL / MO
1,000 DAU	~\$18/mo	Free	Free	~\$18/mo
10,000 DAU	~\$180/mo	\$25/mo	\$20/mo	~\$225/mo
100,000 DAU	~\$1,800/mo	\$200/mo	\$150/mo	~\$2,150/mo
1,000,000 DAU	~\$15,000/mo	\$1,500/mo	\$800/mo	~\$17,300/mo

\$0.017 per user per month at 1M DAU. Less than the cost of one minute of human tutoring. 10,000× efficiency.

Where this goes.

APR 2026

SHIPPED

7-algorithm Socratic engine · Bayesian KT · Metacognitive agent · Live cognitive load visualiser · Export: MD / PDF

Q3 2026

VERNACULAR

Hindi · Tamil · Bengali · Bahasa – no model retraining, prompt layer only · Targets entrance exam aspirants and Tier-3 engineering colleges

Q4 2026

PLATFORM

Teacher dashboard · class-wide BKT heatmaps · coaching institute API · curriculum sequencing via concept prerequisite graph

Q1 2027

SCALE

LMS plugins: Moodle, Canvas · IRT difficulty calibration · personalised Ebbinghaus curves from actual forgetting data · 1M learner target

Four revenue streams. One product.

FREEMIUM

10 sessions/month free · ₹199/month unlimited + export + cross-session memory · Acquisition funnel for B2B conversion

B2B — COACHING INSTITUTES

Physics Wallah · Unacademy · Allen · Byju's · Per-seat monthly license · Value: class-wide understanding analytics, not just grades

B2B — UNIVERSITIES

IIT/NIT DS programs · engineering colleges · Teacher dashboard + curriculum integration · Formative assessment replacement

B2B — ENTERPRISE UPSKILLING

Tech companies upskilling engineers · Measurable skill depth, not course completion · Corporate L&D replacement

// FINAL EPISTEME CHAT DEMO

*"In 2026, every student has access to AI.
Almost none of them are learning."*

*The problem isn't access to information.
It's the absence of someone who will ask:
but why do you think that?*

Episteme is that someone.
At scale. In any language. For free.

VIEW LIVE DEMO